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Subject: Schools and Perspective

PRESENTATION

Topic: Neo-Freudians

The Neo-Freudians are those who expanded, modified, or rejected some aspects of Freud's theories while maintaining the core idea of unconscious influences.

Main Contributors: The main contributors of neo-Freudians are following:

- Alfred Adler
- Carl Jung
- Erik Erikson
- Heinz Kohut
- Ana Freud
- Karen Horney

1. Alfred Adler (1870-1937):

- ☐ Emphasized **social interest** and the importance of social relationships.
- ☐ Introduced the concept of the **inferiority complex**, where feelings of inferiority motivate striving for superiority.
- ☐ Highlighted the role of birth order in personality development.

Theory of birth order:

Alfred Adler (1870-1937) was an **Austrian psychotherapist** who developed birth order theory in the early **20th century**. According to the theory, birth order can affect personality, development, and even life outcomes of a child. Adler considered the "**psychological birth order**" or the perceived position in a family more important than numerical birth order.

Some of the major concepts in Adler's birth order theory include:

- **Firstborn children:**

May get more attention from their parents and develop a sense of responsibility. They may also take up the role of teaching their younger siblings.

- **Middle children:**

May feel the need for attention and may be more competitive. They may also be more independent and live their own lives.

- **Youngest children:**

They may also develop an extroverted personality, humor, and social intelligence. They can try to outdo their elder siblings.

Adler also brought forth the "**family constellation**", a concept that focused on the interactions between family members and how such relationships affected the development of an individual.

2. Carl Jung (1875-1961): Carl Jung was a Swiss psychologist and psychiatrist who founded analytical psychology and helped develop personality theory

Jung's concepts include:

- **Analytical psychology:** Also called Jungian analysis, this is the school of thought that Jung founded.
- **Archetypes:** These are common to all humans, but express themselves differently in each person.
- **Collective unconscious:** Jung believed that the mind is organized in a similar way to the human body, and that it has a biological, prehistoric, and unconscious development.
- **Extraversion and introversion:** These are personality types that Jung proposed.

View of Nature: Jung said not only our past, our present and future will also play an important role in personality building.

Cause of problem: Cause of problem is impairment in archetypes

3. Erik Erikson: (1902-1994): Erik Erikson was a German-born American psychoanalyst and developmental psychologist who is known as the "Father of Psychosocial Development".

Erikson's theory of psychosocial development stages:

Erik Erikson's theory of psychosocial development is a theory that describes how a person's personality develops through eight stages from infancy to old age:

Trust vs. mistrust: The first stage, where children learn to trust

Autonomy vs. shame and doubt: The second stage, where children develop a sense of independence

Initiative vs. guilt: The preschool-age stage

Industry vs. inferiority: The school-age stage

Identity vs. role confusion: The adolescence stage, where adolescents explore their independence and develop a sense of self

Intimacy vs. isolation: The young adulthood stage

Generativity vs. stagnation: The middle age stage

Integrity vs. despair: The older adulthood stage

Erikson's theory suggests that each stage is characterized by a specific psychosocial crisis or challenge that the individual must navigate. By successfully resolving these conflicts, people develop psychological strengths that help them become confident and healthy. Erikson believed that development continues throughout a person's life, and that social experience is valuable at every stage.

4. Heinz Kohut: Heinz Kohut was a psychoanalyst who initially worked in the Freudian tradition, but later developed his own theory of Self-Psychology. Kohut's work is considered to be part of the Neo-Freudian perspective, which is a school of thought that modified Freud's psychoanalytic theory. Kohut's theory of Self-Psychology proposes that people who don't receive the mirroring or idealization they need from their parents may develop a

fragmented sense of self. Kohut also believed that some degree of narcissism is necessary for a child to develop a sense of individuality.

5. Anna Freud: Anna Freud, the daughter of Sigmund Freud, was a Neo-Freudian psychologist. She has been considered by some to have done little more than continue her father's work, she was a pioneer in both ego psychology and the psychoanalysis of children. Accordingly, she deserves to be considered one of the most influential neo-Freudians.

6. Karen Horney

- Critiqued Freud's views on women and introduced a feminist perspective.
- Emphasized the role of cultural and social factors in shaping personality.
- Identified **basic anxiety** stemming from childhood and described coping strategies like moving toward, against, or away from others.

Techniques: Neo-Freudians used techniques like hypnosis, dream analysis, amplification, word association, MBTI, painting and building, early recollection, confrontation, acting “as if”, task setting, push button etc.

Goals: Neo-Freudian theories of personality have several goals, including:

- **Emphasizing social and cultural aspects:** Neo-Freudians focused more on the social environment and cultural effects on personality than Freud, who emphasized biological factors and sexual urges.
- **Being more optimistic:** Neo-Freudians were more optimistic about the potential for personality growth and change in adults than Freud.
- **Rejecting Freud's negative view:** Neo-Freudians rejected Freud's negative view of human nature.

Strengths:

Neo-Freudians expanded on Freud's ideas and made important contributions to psychology:

- They corrected some of Freud's limitations
- They introduced important concepts to the field
- They influenced many later approaches to personality

Weaknesses:

Neo-Freudian theories have been criticized for a number of reasons, including:

- They are often philosophical rather than based on scientific research
- They use biased and questionable data
- Some theories are oversimplified and incomplete
- Jung's theories were based on myths, legends, dreams, and art

